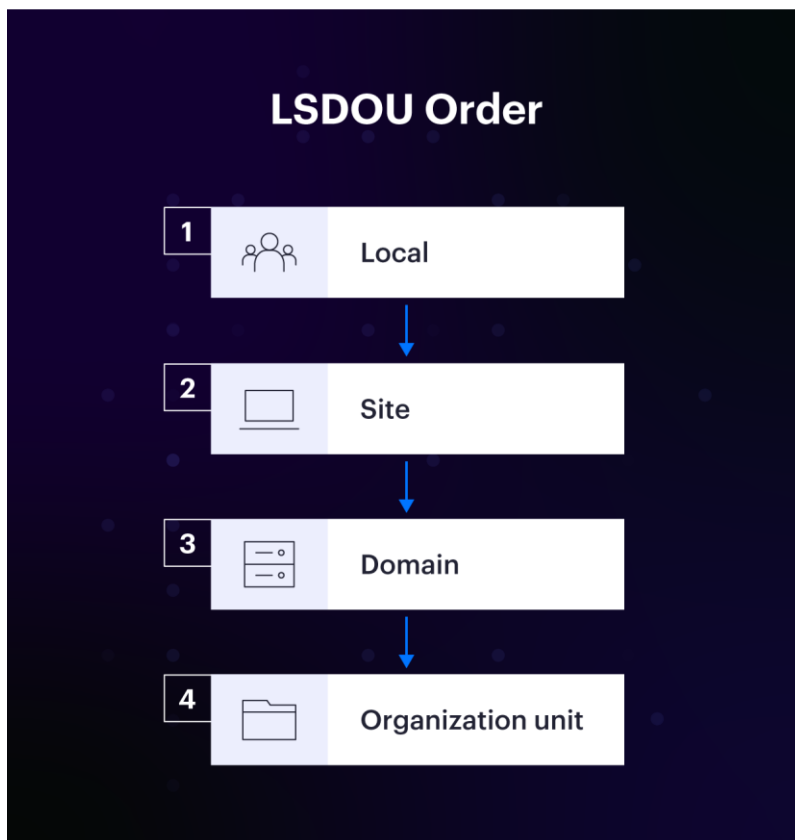


Install and configure GPO and push the policy to client-13

Introduction

Group Policy Object (GPO) is a feature of Windows Server Active Directory that allows administrators to centrally manage and configure operating systems, applications, and user settings. With GPOs, you can enforce security policies, control desktop environments, restrict access, and apply consistent configurations across all client machines in a domain. This reduces administrative workload and ensures uniform policy compliance. We can apply a gpo for like user level OU level.



Step 1: Install Active Directory Domain Services

1. Open **Server Manager**.
2. Click **Add Roles and Features**.
3. Select **Role-based or feature-based installation**.
4. Choose your server and select **Active Directory Domain Services**.
5. Complete the wizard and restart the server if required.

Step 2: Promote the Server to Domain Controller

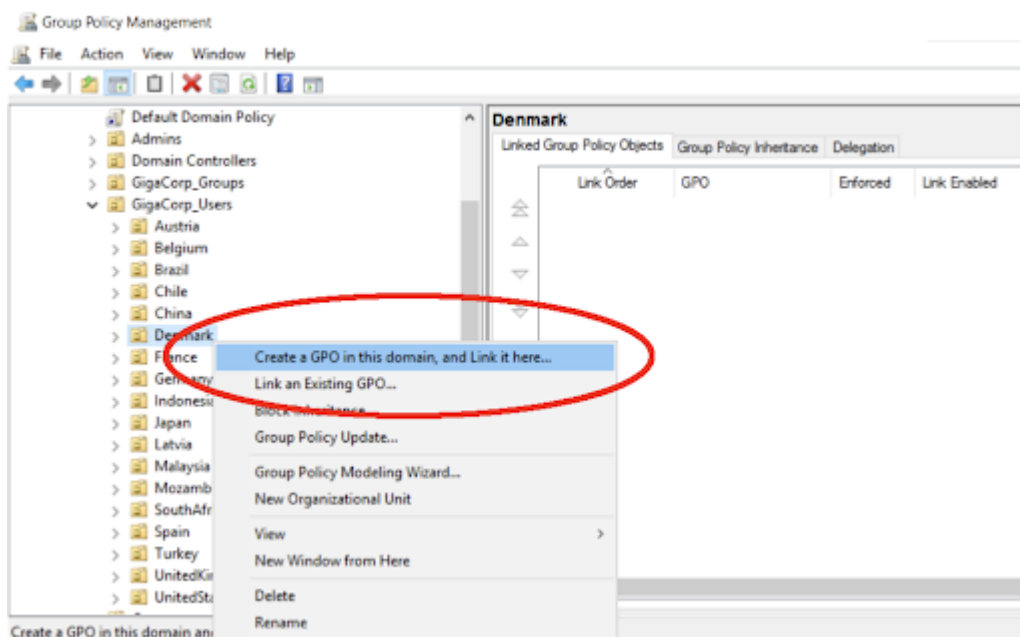
1. In **Server Manager**, click the notification flag and select **Promote this server to a domain controller**.
2. Choose **Add a new forest** and give a domain name (e.g., wipro.com).
3. Set Directory Services Restore Mode (DSRM) password.
4. Complete the installation, and restart the server.

Step 3: Open Group Policy Management Console (GPMC)

1. Log in with domain administrator account.
2. Open **Server Manager** → **Tools** → **Group Policy Management**.
3. You will see your domain (e.g., wipro.com).

Step 4: Create a New GPO

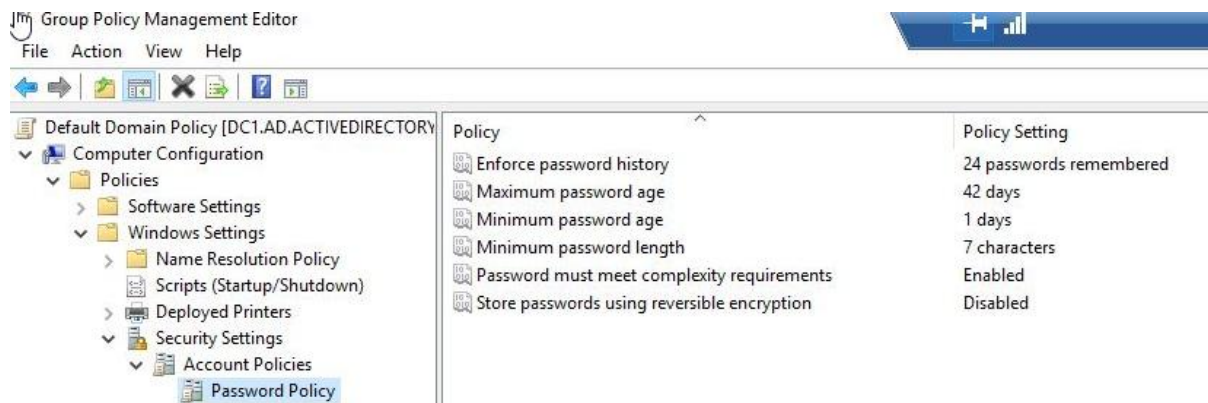
1. Right-click your domain or a specific Organizational Unit (OU).
2. Select **Create a GPO in this domain, and Link it here**.
3. Give it a meaningful name (e.g., “Password Policy” or “Desktop Restrictions”).



Step 5: Edit the GPO

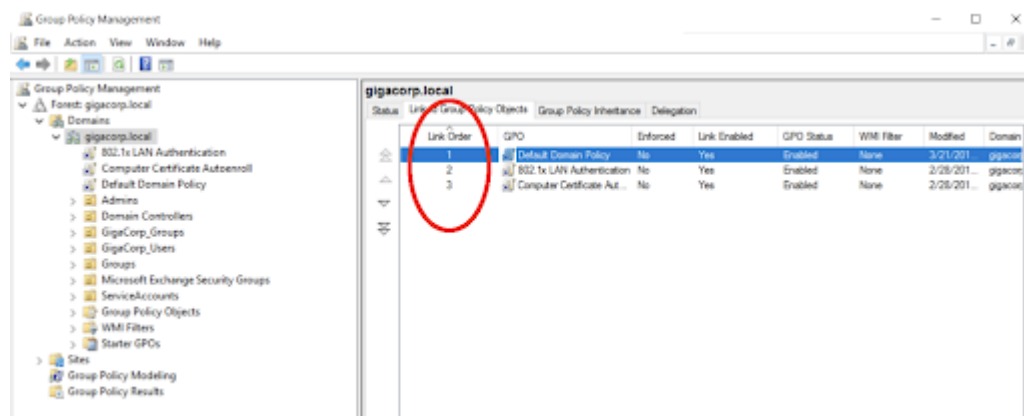
1. Right-click the new GPO and select **Edit**.
2. Use the **Group Policy Management Editor** to configure settings:

- For Computer-based policies: **Computer Configuration → Policies → Administrative Templates → System.**



- For User-based policies: **User Configuration → Policies → Administrative Templates → Desktop.**

3. Example: To enforce password length → **Computer Configuration → Windows Settings → Security Settings → Account Policies → Password Policy.**



Step 6: Apply and Test the Policy

1. Ensure client systems are joined to the domain.
 - On client PC: **System Properties → Change → Domain → enter domain name.**
 - Provide domain admin credentials. Restart client.
2. On client machine, force policy update:
 - Open Command Prompt and run:
 - `gpupdate /force`
3. Verify the policy:
 - Run `gpresult /r` on client PC to check applied policies.

Step 7: Monitor and Troubleshoot

- If policies are not applied, check DNS settings (client must point to domain controller's IP).
- Ensure the client is part of the correct OU.
- Use **Event Viewer** on client to check Group Policy errors.